

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Species and Current Affairs Tracker - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Species and Current Affairs Tracker - Learner-v2 Complete Learning Session

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-03. No PDF was rendered and no tracker or index was mutated.

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

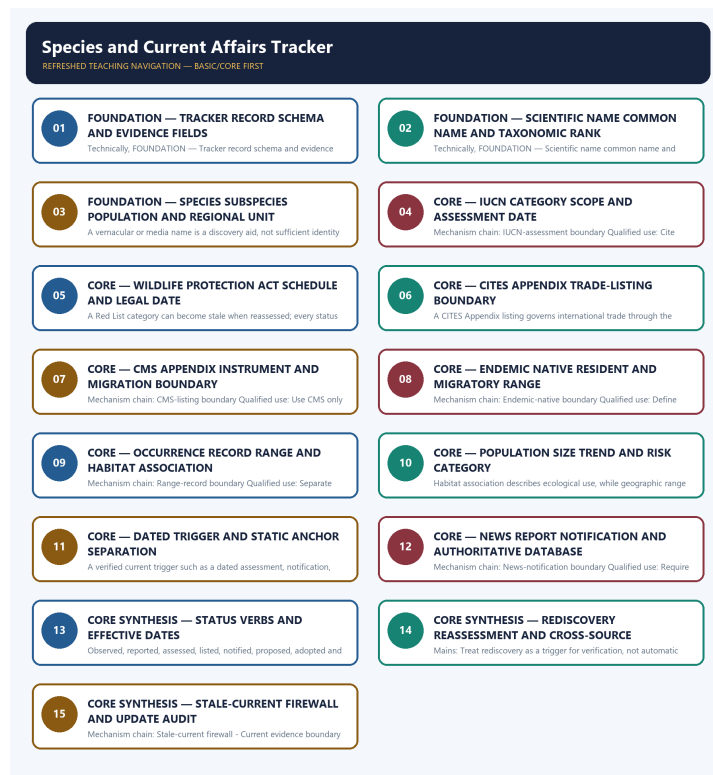
- **Generation date:** 2026-09-03.
- **Repository-first evidence:** the Basic owner is taught first and preserved in full; the Advanced owner is retained only in the optional final teaching block.
- **OCR evidence:** Repository Markdown was primary. OCR-searchable local official General Studies papers were used only to confirm printed routed demands. No answer key, marking scheme, unsupported page precision, ecological rate, species count, pollution standard, rule threshold, mission outcome or current status was inferred.
- **Qdrant:** not used; repository Markdown and available OCR context were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** Audited ledgers route species identity, behaviour, range and institution questions, including provisionally keyed 2026 and answer-free objective demands. No option, species status, range, population or listing is inferred.
- **Live-link boundary:** The CMS species page supplied substantive field-level separation but no selected species update. CITES and IUCN checks failed and the MoEFCC page was unrelated; therefore no current species status, range, population, WPA schedule, CITES or CMS listing, effective date or news claim is asserted.
- **Fact/inference discipline:** no current-affairs item, PYQ wording, figure or quotation is invented.

LIVE OFFICIAL-SOURCE ATTEMPT LOG

The checks below were made on 2026-09-03. Substantive official text is used only for the proposition it supports. Stubs, access failures, unrelated pages and thin landing pages are recorded and are not converted into ecological or current-status claims.

- <https://www.cms.int/en/species> - attempted 2026-09-03; substantive official page structure exposed separate scientific name, common name, class, order, family, instrument and Appendix fields. No species-specific current listing was imported.
- <https://cites.org/eng/app/appendices.php> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official route returned HTTP 403, so no Appendix or effective-date claim was imported.
- <https://www.iucnredlist.org/resources/categories-and-criteria> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official route returned HTTP 520, so no current category, assessment version or species claim was imported.
- <https://www.iucnredlist.org/assessment/process> - attempted 2026-09-03; the official route returned HTTP 520, so no assessment-process wording was imported.
- <https://moef.gov.in/> - attempted 2026-09-03; the fetched page exposed an unrelated recruitment notice, so no Wildlife Protection Act schedule or species notification was imported.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - TRACKER RECORD SCHEMA AND EVIDENCE FIELDS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Tracker-record boundary - Taxonomic-identity boundary Qualified use: Start each record with taxon, claim, source and date fields.

Technical definition: Technically, FOUNDATION - Tracker record schema and evidence fields is analysed by relating FOUNDATION to Tracker record schema, then testing the relationship through evidence fields and Mechanism chain.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Do not use a headline as a tracker record.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- Tracker record schema
- evidence fields
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Tracker-record

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Tracker record schema, connect evidence fields with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

TRACKER RECORD SCHEMA AND EVIDENCE FIELDS

01. Tracker-record boundary

|
v

02. Taxonomic-identity boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not use a headline as a tracker record.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record.
- Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not use a headline as a tracker record.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Start each record with taxon, claim, source and date fields.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Tracker-record boundary -> Taxonomic-identity boundary
- **Qualified use:** Start each record with taxon, claim, source and date fields.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - TRACKER RECORD SCHEMA AND EVIDENCE FIELDS

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Tracker record schema and evidence fields

|
v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • Tracker record schema • evidence fields • Mechanism chain • Qualified use
• Tracker-record

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Tracker-record boundary - Taxonomic-identity boundary

Qualified use: Start each record with taxon, claim, source and date fields.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that do not use a headline as a tracker record.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: do not use a headline as a tracker record.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Do not use a headline as a tracker record.

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - SCIENTIFIC NAME COMMON NAME AND TAXONOMIC RANK

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Species-subspecies boundary Qualified use: Anchor identity in the scientific name and stated rank.

Technical definition: Technically, FOUNDATION - Scientific name common name and taxonomic rank is analysed by relating FOUNDATION to Scientific name common name, then testing the relationship through taxonomic rank and Mechanism chain.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Do not rely on a common name for taxonomic identity.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **Scientific name common name**
- **taxonomic rank**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Scientific name common name, connect taxonomic rank with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SCIENTIFIC NAME COMMON NAME AND TAXONOMIC RANK

01. Species-subspecies boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not rely on a common name for taxonomic identity.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not rely on a common name for taxonomic identity.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Anchor identity in the scientific name and stated rank.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Species-subspecies boundary
- **Qualified use:** Anchor identity in the scientific name and stated rank.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - SCIENTIFIC NAME COMMON NAME AND TAXONOMIC RANK

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Scientific name common name and taxonomic rank

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · Scientific name common name · taxonomic rank · Mechanism chain ·
Qualified use · Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Species-subspecies boundary Qualified use: Anchor identity
in the scientific name and stated rank.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units;
a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: do not rely on a common name for
taxonomic identity.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Do not rely on a common name for taxonomic identity.

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - SPECIES SUBSPECIES POPULATION AND REGIONAL UNIT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Common-name boundary Qualified use: Keep species, subspecies, population and regional units separate.

Technical definition: A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Common-name boundary Qualified use: Keep species, subspecies, population and regional units separate.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- Species subspecies population
- regional unit
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- A vernacular or media name

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Species subspecies population, connect regional unit with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SPECIES SUBSPECIES POPULATION AND REGIONAL UNIT

01. Common-name boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not merge species, subspecies and populations.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not merge species, subspecies and populations.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Keep species, subspecies, population and regional units separate.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Common-name boundary
- **Qualified use:** Keep species, subspecies, population and regional units separate.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - SPECIES SUBSPECIES POPULATION AND REGIONAL UNIT

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Species subspecies population and regional unit

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · Species subspecies population · regional unit · Mechanism chain ·
Qualified use · A vernacular or media name

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Do not merge species, subspecies and populations.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity
evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: keep species, subspecies, population
and regional units separate.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Common-name boundary Qualified use: Keep species,
subspecies, population and regional units separate.

SESSION 4 - CORE - IUCN CATEGORY SCOPE AND ASSESSMENT DATE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: IUCN-assessment boundary Qualified use: Cite IUCN taxon, scope and assessment date together.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **IUCN category scope**
- **assessment date**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **An IUCN Red List category**
- **An IUCN Red List**

How to use them: Frame the answer through IUCN category scope; define assessment date, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use An IUCN Red List category for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

IUCN CATEGORY SCOPE AND ASSESSMENT DATE

01. IUCN-assessment boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not transfer a claim between taxa sharing a common name.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not transfer a claim between taxa sharing a common name.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Cite IUCN taxon, scope and assessment date together.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** IUCN-assessment boundary
- **Qualified use:** Cite IUCN taxon, scope and assessment date together.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - IUCN CATEGORY SCOPE AND ASSESSMENT DATE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - IUCN category scope and assessment date

|

v

EXACT TERMS: IUCN category scope · assessment date · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · An IUCN Red List category · An IUCN Red List

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: IUCN-assessment boundary Qualified use: Cite IUCN taxon, scope and assessment date together.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not transfer a claim between taxa sharing a common name.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: an IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing.

SESSION 5 - CORE - WILDLIFE PROTECTION ACT SCHEDULE AND LEGAL DATE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: IUCN-date boundary Qualified use: Cite the applicable domestic law and legal date separately.

Technical definition: A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Do not call IUCN status a domestic legal schedule.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Wildlife Protection Act schedule
- legal date
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Red List
- IUCN

How to use them: Frame the answer through Wildlife Protection Act schedule; define legal date, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Red List for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

WILDLIFE PROTECTION ACT SCHEDULE AND LEGAL DATE

01. IUCN-date boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not call IUCN status a domestic legal schedule.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not call IUCN status a domestic legal schedule.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Cite the applicable domestic law and legal date separately.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** IUCN-date boundary
- **Qualified use:** Cite the applicable domestic law and legal date separately.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - WILDLIFE PROTECTION ACT SCHEDULE AND LEGAL DATE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Wildlife Protection Act schedule and legal date

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Wildlife Protection Act schedule · legal date · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Red List · IUCN

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: IUCN-date boundary Qualified use: Cite the applicable domestic law and legal date separately.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: do not call IUCN status a domestic legal schedule.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Do not call IUCN status a domestic legal schedule.

SESSION 6 - CORE - CITES APPENDIX TRADE-LISTING BOUNDARY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: WPA-legal boundary - CITES-listing boundary Qualified use: Use CITES only for its trade-control listing question.

Technical definition: A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CITES Appendix trade-listing boundary
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry
- Wildlife
- Protection

How to use them: Frame the answer through CITES Appendix trade-listing boundary; define Mechanism chain, connect Qualified use with A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry to explain the mechanism, and use Wildlife for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

CITES APPENDIX TRADE-LISTING BOUNDARY

01. WPA-legal boundary

|

v

02. CITES-listing boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not cite an IUCN category without an assessment date.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category.
- A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not cite an IUCN category without an assessment date.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Use CITES only for its trade-control listing question.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** WPA-legal boundary -> CITES-listing boundary
- **Qualified use:** Use CITES only for its trade-control listing question.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - CITES APPENDIX TRADE-LISTING BOUNDARY

START / CONCEPT: CORE - CITES Appendix trade-listing boundary

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CITES Appendix trade-listing boundary · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry · Wildlife · Protection

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: WPA-legal boundary - CITES-listing boundary Qualified use: Use CITES only for its trade-control listing question.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not cite an IUCN category without an assessment date.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule.

SESSION 7 - CORE - CMS APPENDIX INSTRUMENT AND MIGRATION BOUNDARY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: CMS-listing boundary Qualified use: Use CMS only for the owned migratory-conservation claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CMS Appendix instrument
- migration boundary
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- CMS Appendix
- Appendix

How to use them: Frame the answer through CMS Appendix instrument; define migration boundary, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use CMS Appendix for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

CMS APPENDIX INSTRUMENT AND MIGRATION BOUNDARY

01. CMS-listing boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not call a WPA schedule an extinction-risk assessment.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not call a WPA schedule an extinction-risk assessment.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Use CMS only for the owned migratory-conservation claim.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** CMS-listing boundary
- **Qualified use:** Use CMS only for the owned migratory-conservation claim.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - CMS APPENDIX INSTRUMENT AND MIGRATION BOUNDARY

START / CONCEPT: CORE - CMS Appendix instrument and migration boundary

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CMS Appendix instrument · migration boundary · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · CMS Appendix · Appendix

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: CMS-listing boundary Qualified use: Use CMS only for the owned migratory-conservation claim.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not call a WPA schedule an extinction-risk assessment.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: use CMS only for the owned migratory-conservation claim.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly.

SESSION 8 - CORE - ENDEMIC NATIVE RESIDENT AND MIGRATORY RANGE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Endemic-native boundary Qualified use: Define endemic and native against an explicit geography.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Endemic native resident
- migratory range
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Endemic
- CITES Appendix

How to use them: Frame the answer through Endemic native resident; define migratory range, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Endemic for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

ENDEMIC NATIVE RESIDENT AND MIGRATORY RANGE

01. Endemic-native boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not call a CITES Appendix an IUCN category.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not call a CITES Appendix an IUCN category.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Define endemic and native against an explicit geography.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Endemic-native boundary
- **Qualified use:** Define endemic and native against an explicit geography.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - ENDEMIC NATIVE RESIDENT AND MIGRATORY RANGE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Endemic native resident and migratory range

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Endemic native resident · migratory range · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Endemic
· CITES Appendix

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Endemic-native boundary Qualified use: Define endemic and native against an explicit geography.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not call a CITES Appendix an IUCN category.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting.

SESSION 9 - CORE - OCCURRENCE RECORD RANGE AND HABITAT ASSOCIATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Range-record boundary Qualified use: Separate occurrence, accepted range and habitat association.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Occurrence record range
- habitat association
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- A verified range
- CMS

How to use them: Frame the answer through Occurrence record range; define habitat association, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use A verified range for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

OCCURRENCE RECORD RANGE AND HABITAT ASSOCIATION

01. Range-record boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not merge CMS migratory status with every international listing.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not merge CMS migratory status with every international listing.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Separate occurrence, accepted range and habitat association.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Range-record boundary
- **Qualified use:** Separate occurrence, accepted range and habitat association.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - OCCURRENCE RECORD RANGE AND HABITAT ASSOCIATION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Occurrence record range and habitat association

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Occurrence record range · habitat association · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · A verified range · CMS

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Range-record boundary Qualified use: Separate occurrence, accepted range and habitat association.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not merge CMS migratory status with every international listing.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: a verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range.

SESSION 10 - CORE - POPULATION SIZE TREND AND RISK CATEGORY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Habitat-range boundary Qualified use: Separate population size, trend and risk assessment.

Technical definition: Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Habitat-range boundary Qualified use: Separate population size, trend and risk assessment.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Population size trend
- risk category
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Habitat association
- Habitat

How to use them: Frame the answer through Population size trend; define risk category, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Habitat association for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

POPULATION SIZE TREND AND RISK CATEGORY

01. Habitat-range boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not infer endemism from prominence or one location.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not infer endemism from prominence or one location.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Separate population size, trend and risk assessment.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Habitat-range boundary
- **Qualified use:** Separate population size, trend and risk assessment.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - POPULATION SIZE TREND AND RISK CATEGORY

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Population size trend and risk category

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Population size trend · risk category · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Habitat association · Habitat

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not infer endemism from prominence or one location.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: separate population size, trend and risk assessment.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Habitat-range boundary Qualified use: Separate population size, trend and risk assessment.

SESSION 11 - CORE - DATED TRIGGER AND STATIC ANCHOR SEPARATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Population-status boundary - Trigger-static boundary Qualified use: Pair each dated trigger with a stable static concept.

Technical definition: A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Population-status boundary - Trigger-static boundary Qualified use: Pair each dated trigger with a stable static concept.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Dated trigger
- static anchor separation
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Population
- Population-status

How to use them: Frame the answer through Dated trigger; define static anchor separation, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Population for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

DATED TRIGGER AND STATIC ANCHOR SEPARATION

01. Population-status boundary

|
v

02. Trigger-static boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not infer stable range expansion from one sighting.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another.
- A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not infer stable range expansion from one sighting.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Pair each dated trigger with a stable static concept.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Population-status boundary -> Trigger-static boundary
- **Qualified use:** Pair each dated trigger with a stable static concept.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - DATED TRIGGER AND STATIC ANCHOR SEPARATION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Dated trigger and static anchor separation

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Dated trigger · static anchor separation · Mechanism chain · Qualified use ·
Population · Population-status

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not infer stable range expansion from one sighting.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Population-status boundary - Trigger-static boundary
Qualified use: Pair each dated trigger with a stable static concept.

SESSION 12 - CORE - NEWS REPORT NOTIFICATION AND AUTHORITATIVE DATABASE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: News-notification boundary Qualified use: Require official notification or database evidence for legal claims.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- News report notification
- authoritative database
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- News-notification
- Qualified

How to use them: Frame the answer through News report notification; define authoritative database, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use News-notification for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

NEWS REPORT NOTIFICATION AND AUTHORITATIVE DATABASE

01. News-notification boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not merge habitat association with geographic range.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not merge habitat association with geographic range.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Require official notification or database evidence for legal claims.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** News-notification boundary
- **Qualified use:** Require official notification or database evidence for legal claims.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - NEWS REPORT NOTIFICATION AND AUTHORITATIVE DATABASE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - News report notification and authoritative database
|
v
EXACT TERMS: News report notification · authoritative database · Mechanism chain · Qualified use ·
News-notification · Qualified
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: News-notification boundary Qualified use: Require official
notification or database evidence for legal claims.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not merge habitat association with geographic range.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: a press report or announcement can
flag an event.
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing
or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative
database entry.

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - STATUS VERBS AND EFFECTIVE DATES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Status-verb boundary Qualified use: Preserve observed, assessed, listed and notified verbs.

Technical definition: Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Status-verb boundary Qualified use: Preserve observed, assessed, listed and notified verbs.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Status verbs
- effective dates
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Observed

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Status verbs, connect effective dates with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

STATUS VERBS AND EFFECTIVE DATES

01. Status-verb boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not infer population trend from risk category.

This topic-specific rule fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not infer population trend from risk category.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Preserve observed, assessed, listed and notified verbs.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Status-verb boundary
- **Qualified use:** Preserve observed, assessed, listed and notified verbs.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - STATUS VERBS AND EFFECTIVE DATES

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Status verbs and effective dates

|
v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Status verbs · effective dates · Mechanism chain · Qualified use ·

Observed

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not infer population trend from risk category.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: preserve observed, assessed, listed and notified verbs.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Status-verb boundary Qualified use: Preserve observed, assessed, listed and notified verbs.

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - REDISCOVERY REASSESSMENT AND CROSS-SOURCE RECONCILIATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mechanism chain: Rediscovery boundary - Cross-source reconciliation Qualified use: Treat rediscovery as a trigger for verification, not automatic reassessment.

Technical definition: Mains: Treat rediscovery as a trigger for verification, not automatic reassessment.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Rediscovery boundary - Cross-source reconciliation Qualified use: Treat rediscovery as a trigger for verification, not automatic reassessment.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Rediscovery reassessment
- cross-source reconciliation
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- IUCN

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Rediscovery reassessment, connect cross-source reconciliation with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

REDISCOVERY REASSESSMENT AND CROSS-SOURCE RECONCILIATION

01. Rediscovery boundary

|
v

02. Cross-source reconciliation

BOUNDARY -> Do not merge a dated trigger with the static anchor.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend. IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend.
- IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not merge a dated trigger with the static anchor.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Treat rediscovery as a trigger for verification, not automatic reassessment.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Rediscovery boundary -> Cross-source reconciliation
- **Qualified use:** Treat rediscovery as a trigger for verification, not automatic reassessment.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - REDISCOVERY REASSESSMENT AND CROSS-SOURCE RECONCILIATION

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Rediscovery reassessment and cross-source reconciliation

|
v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Rediscovery reassessment · cross-source reconciliation · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · IUCN

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Mains: Treat rediscovery as a trigger for verification, not automatic reassessment.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Rediscovery boundary - Cross-source reconciliation
Qualified use: Treat rediscovery as a trigger for verification, not automatic reassessment.

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - STALE-CURRENT FIREWALL AND UPDATE AUDIT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: CCCs are denominated in tCO₂e and traded on power exchanges. **FACT:CURRENT:** EU: CBAM begins replacing free allocation from 2026; EU ETS2 (buildings, road transport, small industry) to be implemented by 2027; offsets discontinued in EU ETS Phase 4. **FACT:CURRENT:** Surat, Gujarat - world's first particulate-matter emissions trading scheme: 317 plants, mandatory CEMS, 20-30% lower particulate emissions and 11-14% lower abatement costs (Greenstone, Pande, Ryan & Sudarshan, QJE, 2025, cited in Economic Survey **FACT:CURRENT:** PARIVESH 3.0; Environment Audit Rules, 2025 (certified third-party auditors); uniform SPCB consent guidelines; industry categories extended to include Blue; blanket 33% green-cover requirement for industrial estates). **FACT:CURRENT:** Jan Vishwas decriminalisation of the EPA 1986, Air Act 1981 and Indian Forest Act Environment Protection (Management of Contaminated Sites) Rules, 2025.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Stale-current firewall - Current evidence boundary Qualified use: Close every current entry with as-of date, recheck rule and honest omission log.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: Stale-current firewall - Current evidence boundary Qualified use: Close every current entry with as-of date, recheck rule and honest omission log.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Stale-current firewall
- update audit
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Subject

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Stale-current firewall, connect update audit with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

STALE-CURRENT FIREWALL AND UPDATE AUDIT

01. Stale-current firewall

|
v

02. Current evidence boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not rewrite a news report as a legal notification.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes.
- Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not rewrite a news report as a legal notification.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact receiving medium, system boundary, measured parameter, actor, process, spatial and temporal scale, rule vintage and scientific or legal status; never turn a context-dependent pattern into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Close every current entry with as-of date, recheck rule and honest omission log.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Stale-current firewall -> Current evidence boundary
- **Qualified use:** Close every current entry with as-of date, recheck rule and honest omission log.

COMPLETE BASIC OWNER EVIDENCE BANK

Subject: Environment and Ecology | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS Paper:** GS-III (Environment) + Prelims, current-affairs integration across all GS papers. **Core area:** Dated species and policy current-affairs tracking methodology. **Grounded in:** PIB press releases; MoEFCC/NTCA/Ramsar Convention/IUCN official updates; audited UPSC Environment PYQs (2024-2026 Prelims and 2024-2025 Mains). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical linkage | **CURRENT:** = dated current-affairs anchor. **Companion:** advanced/28_Species-and-Current-Affairs-Tracker.md.

1. Visual foundation

HOW TO USE THIS TRACKER FILE

Static concept (Topics 01-27) + Dated current anchor (this file) = Exam-ready answer

v	v
"What is a Ramsar site?"	"India reached 100 Ramsar sites on
(Topic 07)	5 June 2026 - PIB PRID 2269208"
+-----> COMBINED ANSWER: definition + latest verified fact <---+	

RULE: Every entry below MUST carry its exact source and date. If a claim cannot be verified against an official source (PIB/MoEFCC/NTCA/Ramsar/IUCN/CMS/CITES), it is OMITTED here rather than guessed.

Core proposition: This tracker file exists specifically to hold time-sensitive, frequently updated facts (new Ramsar sites, new Tiger Reserves, species IUCN-status changes, new COP outcomes) separately from the stable conceptual files (Topics 01-27), so that updating current affairs never requires rewriting the underlying concept explanations -

always pair a static-concept file with this tracker's latest verified entry for a complete answer.

2. Essential definitions

Concept	Exam-ready meaning
FACT: Current-affairs anchor	A specific, dated, source-attributed fact (e.g., a new protected-area notification, a species status change) used to update or exemplify a static concept.
FACT: Source attribution	Citing the exact originating document (PIB press release ID, MoEFCC notification, official convention Secretariat announcement) and its date for any dated claim.
FACT: Milestone tracking	Recording significant threshold events (e.g., India's 100th Ramsar site, a new Tiger Reserve count) as they occur, each with its precise date.
FACT: Status-change tracking	Recording changes in a species' IUCN Red List category, CITES Appendix listing, or Wildlife Protection Act Schedule, each with its effective date.

3. Topic mechanism

1. Static conceptual knowledge (Topics 01-27) explains *what* a Ramsar site, Tiger Reserve, IUCN category or COP mechanism *is* and *how it works* - this foundational knowledge does not change year to year.
2. Current affairs supply the *latest specific instance* of that concept (e.g., which wetland became India's 100th Ramsar site, which reserve became the 58th Tiger Reserve, which COP made which finance decision) - this changes frequently and must be tracked separately with precise dates.
3. A complete, exam-ready answer combines both layers: the static concept explains the mechanism and significance; the current-affairs anchor supplies the specific, dated, verifiable fact that demonstrates active, up-to-date knowledge.
4. This tracker file should be periodically updated (whenever a genuinely new, verified milestone or status change occurs) rather than treated as a one-time, static document - its value depends on continued, disciplined updating with accurate source attribution.
5. When a specific figure or claim cannot be verified against an official primary source at the time of updating, it should be omitted entirely rather than estimated or approximated, preserving this tracker's reliability as a fact-checked reference.

4. Institutions and policy tools

- FACT: **PIB (Press Information Bureau)**: primary official source for Government of India announcements, including environment-related milestones (each release carries a citable PRID number).
- FACT: **MoEFCC**: source for notifications on protected areas, Schedule changes, and policy updates.
- FACT: **NTCA**: source for Tiger Reserve count and tiger-census updates.
- FACT: **Ramsar Convention Secretariat**: source for the official global Ramsar site count and designations.
- FACT: **IUCN**: source for Red List category updates.
- ANALYSIS: Secondary sources (news reports, coaching-material summaries) should be cross-checked against these primary sources before being treated as verified facts in this tracker.

5. Verified current entries (each dated and source-attributed)

- FACT:CURRENT: **CBD COP16 - Cali 2024/resumed Rome 2025**: DSI benefit-sharing was operationalised through the Cali Fund, alongside finance and KMGBF-monitoring decisions (source: CBD Secretariat).
- FACT:CURRENT: **Ramsar sites - India reached 100 Ramsar sites on 5 June 2026** (World Environment

Day), with the Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Surha Tal), Ballia district, Uttar Pradesh, as the 100th site (source: PIB PRID 2269208; Ramsar Convention Secretariat). At this point, India held the highest number of Ramsar sites in Asia (verify any updated global comparative ranking against the latest Ramsar Secretariat data before citing further).

- FACT:CURRENT: **Tiger Reserves - India's count reached 58** with Madhav Tiger Reserve (Madhya Pradesh) notified in March 2025, following Ratapani Tiger Reserve (Madhya Pradesh) in December 2024 (source: NTCA/MoEFCC notifications; verify the latest count before citing, as new reserves are periodically added).
- FACT:CURRENT: **Biosphere Reserves - India has 18 notified Biosphere Reserves**; 13 are in UNESCO's World Network after Cold Desert (Himachal Pradesh) joined in 2025 (MoEFCC/UNESCO, verified 2026). Keep the UNESCO subset distinct from the domestic total.
- FACT:CURRENT: **Protected areas - as of March 2025** (WII ENVIS Protected Area Database), India had 106 National Parks, 573 Wildlife Sanctuaries, 115 Conservation Reserves and 220 Community Reserves (verify the latest database update before citing a specific count).
- FACT:CURRENT: **Forest cover - ISFR 2023** (released December 2024): total forest and tree cover of 8,27,357 sq km, 25.17% of India's geographical area (forest cover 21.76%, tree cover 3.41%).
- FACT:CURRENT: **Climate finance - COP29 (Baku, 2024)**: New Collective Quantified Goal (NCQG) of at least USD 300 billion/year by 2035 (developed-to-developing), with a broader USD 1.3 trillion/year aspirational total-mobilisation goal via the Baku-to-Belém Roadmap, carried forward at COP30 (Belém, 2025).
- FACT:CURRENT: **Great Indian Bustard**: Critically Endangered (IUCN). In ****M.K. Ranjitsinh & Ors. v. Union of India** (Supreme Court, 21 March 2024) **the Court modified its April 2021 blanket direction on undergrounding overhead power lines across bustard habitat, substituting an expert-committee-led, area-specific feasibility assessment, and in the same judgment recognised a right against the adverse effects of climate change**** under Articles 14 and 21 - verify the latest order date and expert-committee status before citing case progress.

5A. Verified entries added on this reevaluation (2 August 2026)

Energy and climate - Economic Survey 2025-26, Chapter 10 (Government of India):

- FACT:CURRENT: ****Non-fossil capacity: 51.93% of India's installed power capacity at end-December 2025**** - the ~50%-by-2030 NDC target met ahead of schedule (Ministry of Power data).
- FACT:CURRENT: **38.61 GW of renewable capacity added in 2025-26 up to 31 December 2025** - 30.16 GW solar, 4.47 GW wind, 3.24 GW hydro, 0.03 GW bio-power (MNRE).
- FACT:CURRENT: **India ranks 4th globally in installed renewable capacity** (after China, the USA and Brazil) - IRENA, *Renewable Energy Statistics 2025*.
- FACT:CURRENT: **Solar: ~3 GW (2014) -> 135.81 GW (December 2025)**; **PM Surya Ghar: 8 GW rooftop; 55 solar parks** approved (39,973 MW sanctioned, 16,121 MW installed).
- FACT:CURRENT: **Wind: 54.51 GW (December 2025)** - 4th highest in the world; 83.35 billion units generated in 2024-25.
- FACT:CURRENT: **Nuclear: installed capacity ~8,780 MW**; CEA roadmap for **100 GW by 2047**; Nuclear Energy Mission (Budget 2025-26, Rs 20,000 crore) targeting **≥5 indigenous SMRs by 2033** (BSMR-200 and SMR-55).
- FACT:CURRENT: **SHANTI Act, December 2025** - consolidates the Atomic Energy Act, 1962 and the Civil Liability for Nuclear Damage Act, 2010; permits private-sector and state participation; graded liability framework.
- FACT:CURRENT: **National Green Hydrogen Mission: 862,000 t/yr** of green-hydrogen capacity **allocated to 18 companies; 3,000 MW/yr of electrolyser manufacturing awarded to 15 firms; three Green Hydrogen Hubs** - Deendayal Port (Gujarat), V.O. Chidambaranar Port (Tamil Nadu) and Paradip Port (Odisha).
ANALYSIS: *Allocated/awarded*, not commissioned.

- FACT:CURRENT: **Storage:** CEA projects **411 GWh of battery storage needed by 2031-32**; ACC PLI covers 50 GWh, of which 10 GWh is earmarked for grid-scale storage.
- FACT:CURRENT: **Adaptation expenditure reached 5.6% of GDP in FY22** (India's Initial Adaptation Communication / Third National Communication, 2023).
- FACT:CURRENT: **NAPCC is now described by the Government as nine missions**, the ninth being on **health** - state "eight originally, nine as currently described".

Carbon markets and regulation:

- FACT:CURRENT: **CCTS adopted June 2023**; ****2025: pro-rata GEI targets notified for four sectors** - Aluminium, Cement, Chlor-Alkali, Pulp and Paper; offset mechanism approved for 10 sectors** including CCUS. CCCs are denominated in tCO₂e and traded on power exchanges.
- FACT:CURRENT: **EU: CBAM begins replacing free allocation from 2026; EU ETS2** (buildings, road transport, small industry) to be implemented **by 2027**; offsets discontinued in EU ETS Phase 4.
- FACT:CURRENT: **Surat, Gujarat - world's first particulate-matter emissions trading scheme:** 317 plants, mandatory CEMS, **20-30% lower particulate emissions** and **11-14% lower abatement costs** (Greenstone, Pande, Ryan & Sudarshan, *QJE*, 2025, cited in Economic Survey 2025-26, Box X.9).
- FACT:CURRENT: **PARIVESH 3.0; Environment Audit Rules, 2025** (certified third-party auditors); uniform SPCB consent guidelines; industry categories extended to include **Blue**; **October 2025** green-belt norms rationalised by pollution potential (replacing the blanket 33% green-cover requirement for industrial estates).
- FACT:CURRENT: **Jan Vishwas decriminalisation** of the EPA 1986, Air Act 1981 and Indian Forest Act 1927; **Water Act 1974** criminal provisions amended under **Article 252(1)**; **Environment Protection (Management of Contaminated Sites) Rules, 2025**.

Waste and circular economy:

- FACT:CURRENT: **EPR portal as on 14 November 2025: 69,116 producers and 4,377 recyclers** registered; **~308 lakh tonnes** recycled; **296.53 lakh tonnes** of EPR certificates generated. EPR now spans **eight streams**; **Circular Economy Action Plans cover 10 waste categories** (including solar panels and gypsum).
- FACT:CURRENT: **12 single-use plastic items banned from 1 July 2022**; plastic carry-bag thickness raised to **120 microns**.

Biodiversity and coasts:

- FACT:CURRENT: ****Biological Diversity (Access to Biological Resources and Knowledge Associated thereto and Fair and Equitable Sharing of Benefits) Regulations, 2025 - extend to digital sequence information****.
- FACT:CURRENT: **MISHTI: ~540 sq km** of mangrove restoration across ****9 coastal States and 4 UTs, 2023-2028**; **~22.8 million person-days of employment**; **estimated carbon sink ~4.5 million tonnes****. ANALYSIS: Targets/estimates, not achievements.

International science and treaty calendar:

- FACT:CURRENT: **IPCC AR7 cycle** (ipcc.ch, verified 2 August 2026): three Working Group reports agreed at **IPCC-60 (Istanbul, January 2024)**; **Special Report on Climate Change and Cities** outlined at **IPCC-61 (Sofia, July-August 2024)**; Working Group outlines agreed at **IPCC-62 (Hangzhou, February 2025)**; the **2027 Methodology Report on Carbon Dioxide Removal Technologies, CCUS** agreed at **IPCC-63 (Lima, October 2025)**; **AR7 Synthesis Report due by late 2029**; plus a **2027 Methodology Report on Inventories for Short-Lived Climate Forcers**. ANALYSIS: **AR6 (2023) remains the latest completed assessment**.
- FACT:CURRENT: **UNCCD COP17: Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia, 17-28 August 2026**, theme *****"Restoring Land. Restoring Hope"**; 197 Parties; **UNCCD states up to 40% of the world's land is already degraded (unccd.int, verified 2 August 2026)**. ANALYSIS: Scheduled, not concluded.**
- FACT:CURRENT: **2026 is the UN International Year of Rangelands and Pastoralists (IYRP) -**

rangelands cover more than half the Earth's land surface, support ~500 million people's livelihoods and provide about one-sixth of global nutrition (unccd.int).

- FACT:CURRENT: **CBD COP16 (Cali 2024; resumed Rome, February 2025): Cali Fund** for DSI benefit-sharing; **permanent subsidiary body on Article 8(j)** for indigenous peoples and local communities.

- FACT:CURRENT: **First Global Stocktake, COP28 (Dubai, 2023):** the "UAE Consensus" called for **transitioning away from fossil fuels in energy systems** and for **tripling renewable capacity and doubling the energy-efficiency improvement rate by 2030**; the **Loss and Damage Fund** (agreed COP27, 2022) was **operationalised**.

ANALYSIS: **Deliberate omissions (not oversights):** this tracker does **not** state a CITES CoP session number, host or listing outcome for the most recent CoP; a Ramsar COP session number or global site total; a UNFCCC COP after Belém (2025); India's post-2025 NDC submission status; a global biodiversity-hotspot count; or India's exact Kigali HFC phase-down schedule. Each was not verifiable against a first-party source at the time of this reevaluation and is therefore omitted rather than estimated, in line with the rule stated in Section 1.

6. Must-Know Facts for Prelims

- FACT: India's Ramsar site count reached 100 on 5 June 2026 (PIB PRID 2269208) - the single most recent major wetland-conservation milestone to know precisely.
- FACT: India's Tiger Reserve count reached 58 with Madhav Tiger Reserve (March 2025).
- FACT: ISFR 2023 (released December 2024) is the most recent forest-cover assessment, reporting 25.17% total forest and tree cover.
- FACT: COP29 (Baku, 2024) and COP30 (Belém, 2025) are the most recent major UNFCCC Conference of the Parties sessions, with the NCQG climate-finance outcome as their headline result.
- FACT: Always cite the specific source and date for any dated fact used in an answer - never present a current-affairs figure as a permanent, unchanging constant.
- FACT: ****India crossed 50% non-fossil installed capacity ahead of schedule - 51.93% at end-December 2025**** (Economic Survey 2025-26, Ch. 10). This is the single most citable Indian climate achievement of the current cycle.
- FACT: **UNCCD COP17 is at Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia, 17-28 August 2026** ("Restoring Land. Restoring Hope"), and **2026 is the UN International Year of Rangelands and Pastoralists**.
- FACT: **AR6 (2023) is still the latest completed IPCC assessment**; the AR7 Synthesis Report is due by **late 2029**.
- FACT: **The SHANTI Act (December 2025)** opened India's nuclear sector to private and state participation.

7. UPSC traps

- WRONG: Current-affairs figures (Ramsar count, Tiger Reserve count, forest-cover percentage) are fixed, unchanging numbers to memorise once and reuse indefinitely. -> They are dated snapshots that change as new notifications/reports are issued - always verify and cite the source/date.
- WRONG: A number seen in a coaching-material summary can be cited without independent verification. -> Cross-check against the primary official source (PIB/MoEFCC/NTCA/ Ramsar/IUCN) before treating it as reliable.
- WRONG: Static concept knowledge and current-affairs facts are interchangeable substitutes for each other. -> A complete answer needs both: the concept explains significance/mechanism, the current fact demonstrates up-to-date awareness.
- WRONG: Every environment-related news item is equally exam-relevant. -> Prioritise items with clear GS-paper linkage, PYQ precedent, or genuine policy/legal significance over decorative or purely descriptive news items.

8. CURRENT: Current anchor

- **CURRENT:** This tracker's entries (Section 5) are the most recent verified facts as of this file's last update; before any exam-preparation use, cross-check each entry against its cited primary source for any subsequent update, since environmental current affairs (new Ramsar sites, reserve counts, COP outcomes, species status changes) continue to evolve after this file's compilation date.

ANALYSIS: Interpretation caution: treat this file as a living document requiring periodic refresh - an outdated entry that is not re-verified risks becoming a source of factual error in an exam answer.

9. PYQ application

- **ANALYSIS:** Recurring Prelims pattern: questions increasingly combine a static concept with a requirement to identify or apply the latest verified current-affairs instance of that concept (e.g., "which of the following is India's most recently added Ramsar site").
- **ANALYSIS:** Mains linkage: dated current anchors (COP29/30 outcomes, Ramsar milestone, Tiger Reserve expansion) provide the "CURRENT: current anchor" evidence expected in a well-rounded GS-III answer.

10. Mains angles

- **ANALYSIS:** Argue that credible environmental answers require combining stable conceptual understanding with precisely dated, source-attributed current facts, not one without the other.
- **ANALYSIS:** Use the milestone-tracking discipline (always citing source and date) as a model answer-writing practice for any current-affairs-heavy GS-III topic.
- **ANALYSIS:** Conclude with a verification-discipline thesis: in a fast-moving policy area, intellectual honesty about what is verified versus uncertain is itself a valued examination skill.

Answer thesis: Pair every static Environment-and-Ecology concept (Topics 01-27) with this tracker's latest verified, source-dated current-affairs instance, and maintain strict verification discipline - omitting any unverifiable figure rather than guessing - as the standard for exam-ready, credible answers.

11. Probable questions

- **ANALYSIS: Prelims:** Identify the most recent verified milestone for a named category (Ramsar sites, Tiger Reserves, Biosphere Reserves) as tracked in this file.
- **ANALYSIS: Mains (10 marks):** Why must environmental current-affairs facts always be cited with their specific source and date rather than presented as fixed figures?
- **ANALYSIS: Mains (15 marks):** Using this tracker's verified entries, construct an integrated answer combining biodiversity-conservation policy with India's recent international climate-negotiation outcomes.

12. Study links

- **FACT:** Advanced companion: `advanced/28_Species-and-Current-Affairs-Tracker.md`.
- **FACT:** `07_Biosphere-Reserves-and-Ramsar-Sites.md` - the Ramsar milestone's conceptual context.
- **FACT:** `06_Protected-Area-Network-India.md` - the Tiger Reserve count's conceptual context.
- **FACT:** `19_UNFCCC-COP-Kyoto-Paris-Agreement.md` - the COP29/30 climate-finance outcomes' conceptual context.

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md`. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	36	Foxtail orchid distribution, epiphytic habit, and State-flower status	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans - 2026 - GS1 - Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Foxtail orchid distribution, epiphytic habit, and State-flower status

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented:** 2024, 2025
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Prelims GS-I	25	Behaviour of big cats (lions, cheetahs, leopards)	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2025	Prelims GS-I	37	Peacock (Gooty) tarantula - endemic species	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Behaviour of big cats (lions, cheetahs, leopards)
- Peacock (Gooty) tarantula - endemic species

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

13. Core answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

13.1 Current-affairs evidence protocol

Use a current fact only after recording: **issuer/source** -> **publication or as-on date** -> **status verb** -> **what the fact proves** -> **what it does not prove**.

Status verb	Safe use	Unsafe substitution
Announced/targeted	policy intention	achievement
Notified/designated	legal or administrative status	operational protection/outcome
Allocated/sanctioned	committed capacity/funding	commissioned output
Installed/commissioned/achieved	physical milestone	quality, utilisation or long-term effect

13.2 Reusable evidence units

Claim	Named evidence/example -> significance	Qualification
Designation counts need implementation context.	100 Ramsar sites, 5 June 2026; 58 Tiger Reserves, March 2025 milestone -> shows expansion/recognition.	Verify later updates and do not treat count as management effectiveness.
Energy progress needs unit discipline.	51.93% non-fossil installed capacity at end-December 2025 -> dated capacity milestone.	Not generation share, energy-requirements share or proof that every target is met.
Treaty calendars are status-sensitive.	AR6 completed; AR7 cycle under way; UNCCD COP17 scheduled for 17-28 August 2026 -> adds current context.	A scheduled COP, agreed outline or announced fund is not a concluded outcome/disbursement.

13.3 Mark-scaled spines

- **10 marks:** make one static mechanism claim, add one dated current evidence unit and one limitation.
- **15/20 marks:** use two or three cross-topic evidence units (for example Ramsar-wetland governance, COP finance-India policy, or species science-law-court), explicitly label each source/date/status.
- Do not guess: current IUCN categories, treaty Appendix/COP outcomes, current protected-area counts, NDC status, capacity generation shares or case implementation. A bounded omission is safer than false precision.

13.4 2026 species fact card - foxtail orchid

Foxtail orchid (Rhynchostylis retusa) is an **epiphyte**: it uses a host tree for physical support, not as a parasite drawing nutrients from it. It is not endemic to north-east India; it has a wider tropical Asian range. It is the State flower of **Assam and Arunachal Pradesh**. These are taxonomy/distribution/status distinctions; do not convert cultural association with Assam into endemism.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 13

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Prelims GS-I	86	Prosopis juliflora invasive plant ecological biodiversity impact	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	31	Himalayan nettle Girardinia diversifolia sustainable uses	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	72	Indian elephants ecology gestation calving and state distribution	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	74	Indian bird species frogmouth barbet minivet redstart identification	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2020	Prelims GS-I	77	Musk deer natural habitat in Himalayan protected areas	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	21	Plants used as natural mosquito repellents	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	23	Animals rolling up to protect vulnerable body parts	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	63	Moringa drumstick tamarind tree properties and uses	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	Prelims GS-I	45	Himalayan forest fungus species characteristics and cultivation	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Stem verified against official scan; OCR artifact resolved; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	14	Nocturnal behaviour among Indian fauna species	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	15	Waggle dance communication in honeybee colonies	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	17	Indian squirrel nesting food-storage and dietary behaviour	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	19	Orangutan tool-making behaviour stick scraping insects	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Prosopis juliflora invasive plant ecological biodiversity impact
- Himalayan nettle Girardinia diversifolia sustainable uses
- Indian elephants ecology gestation calving and state distribution
- Indian bird species frogmouth barbet minivet redstart identification
- Musk deer natural habitat in Himalayan protected areas
- Plants used as natural mosquito repellents
- Animals rolling up to protect vulnerable body parts
- Moringa drumstick tamarind tree properties and uses
- Himalayan forest fungus species characteristics and cultivation
- Nocturnal behaviour among Indian fauna species
- Waggle dance communication in honeybee colonies
- Indian squirrel nesting food-storage and dietary behaviour
- Orangutan tool-making behaviour stick scraping insects

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - STALE-CURRENT FIREWALL AND UPDATE AUDIT

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Stale-current firewall and update audit

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Stale-current firewall · update audit · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Subject

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Keep the UNESCO subset distinct from the domestic total. FACT:CURRENT: Protected areas - as of March 2025 (WII ENVIS Protected Area Database), India had 106 National Parks, 573 Wildlife Sanctuaries, 115 Conservation Reserves and 220 Community Reserves (verify the latest database update before citing a specific count). FACT:CURRENT: Forest cover - ISFR 2023 (released December 2024): total forest and tree cover of 8,27,357 sq km, 25.17% of India's geographical area (forest cover 21.76%, tree cover 3.41%). FACT:CURRENT: Climate finance - COP29 (Baku, 2024): New Collective Quantified Goal (NCQG) of at least USD 300 billion/year by 2035 (developed-to-developing), with a broader USD 1.3 trillion/year aspirational total-mobilisation goal via the Baku-to-Belém Roadmap, carried forward at COP30 (Belém, 2025). FACT:CURRENT: Great Indian Bustard: Critically Endangered (IUCN).

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Do not rewrite a news report as a legal notification.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Each was not verifiable against a first-party source at the time of this reevaluation and is therefore omitted rather than estimated, in line with the rule stated in Section 1.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: Stale-current firewall - Current evidence boundary
Qualified use: Close every current entry with as-of date, recheck rule and honest omission log.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Tracker-record boundary?

A. A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. B. Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. C. Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another. D. A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry.

Answer: A. Explanation: A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q2. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Tracker-record boundary?

A. An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. B. A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. C. A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry. D. Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another.

Answer: B. Explanation: A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q3. Which statement uses Tracker-record boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. B. A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. C. A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. D. A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry.

Answer: C. Explanation: A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Tracker-record boundary?

A. A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. B. An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. C. A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. D. A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record.

Answer: D. Explanation: A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Taxonomic-identity boundary?

A. Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. B. Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another. C. An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. D. A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry.

Answer: A. Explanation: Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q6. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Taxonomic-identity boundary?

A. A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. B. Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. C. An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. D. A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry.

Answer: B. Explanation: Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q7. Which statement uses Taxonomic-identity boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. B. A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. C. Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. D. An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing.

Answer: C. Explanation: Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Taxonomic-identity boundary?

A. A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. B. A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. C. A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. D. Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region.

Answer: D. Explanation: Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Species-subspecies boundary?

A. Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another. B. A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. C. An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. D. A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry.

Answer: A. Explanation: Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q10. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Species-subspecies boundary?

A. A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. B. Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another. C. An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. D. A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category.

Answer: B. Explanation: Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q11. Which statement uses Species-subspecies boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. B. A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. C. Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another. D. A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse.

Answer: C. Explanation: Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Species-subspecies boundary?

A. A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. B. A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. C. A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. D. Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another.

Answer: D. Explanation: Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Common-name boundary?

A. A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry. B. A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. C. A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. D. An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing.

Answer: A. Explanation: A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q14. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Common-name boundary?

A. A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. B. A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry. C. A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. D. A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule.

Answer: B. Explanation: A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q15. Which statement uses Common-name boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. B. A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. C. A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry. D. A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly.

Answer: C. Explanation: A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Common-name boundary?

A. A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. B. Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. C. A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. D. A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry.

Answer: D. Explanation: A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies IUCN-assessment boundary?

A. An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. B. A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. C. A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. D. A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category.

Answer: A. Explanation: An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q18. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of IUCN-assessment boundary?

A. A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. B. An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. C. A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. D. A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category.

Answer: B. Explanation: An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q19. Which statement uses IUCN-assessment boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. B. A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. C. An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. D. Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting.

Answer: C. Explanation: An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about IUCN-assessment boundary?

A. Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. B. A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range. C. A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. D. An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing.

Answer: D. Explanation: An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies IUCN-date boundary?

A. A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. B. A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. C. A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. D. A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly.

Answer: A. Explanation: A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q22. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of IUCN-date boundary?

A. A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. B. A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. C. Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. D. A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule.

Answer: B. Explanation: A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q23. Which statement uses IUCN-date boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. B. A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range. C. A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. D. A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly.

Answer: C. Explanation: A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about IUCN-date boundary?

A. Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. B. A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range. C. Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. D. A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse.

Answer: D. Explanation: A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies WPA-legal boundary?

A. A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. B. A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. C. A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. D. Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting.

Answer: A. Explanation: A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q26. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of WPA-legal boundary?

A. A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. B. A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. C. A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range. D. Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting.

Answer: B. Explanation: A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q27. Which statement uses WPA-legal boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. B. Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. C. A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. D. A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range.

Answer: C. Explanation: A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about WPA-legal boundary?

A. Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. B. A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range. C. Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. D. A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category.

Answer: D. Explanation: A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies CITES-listing boundary?

A. A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. B. A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. C. Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. D. A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range.

Answer: A. Explanation: A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q30. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of CITES-listing boundary?

A. Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. B. A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. C. Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. D. A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range.

Answer: B. Explanation: A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q31. Which statement uses CITES-listing boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. B. Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. C. A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. D. A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range.

Answer: C. Explanation: A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CITES-listing boundary?

A. Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. B. A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. C. Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. D. A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule.

Answer: D. Explanation: A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies CMS-listing boundary?

A. A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. B. Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. C. Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. D. A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range.

Answer: A. Explanation: A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q34. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of CMS-listing boundary?

A. Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. B. A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. C. A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range. D. Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another.

Answer: B. Explanation: A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q35. Which statement uses CMS-listing boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. B. Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. C. A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. D. A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates.

Answer: C. Explanation: A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CMS-listing boundary?

A. A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. B. Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. C. A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. D. A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly.

Answer: D. Explanation: A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Endemic-native boundary?

A. Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. B. A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range. C. Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. D. Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs.

Answer: A. Explanation: Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q38. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Endemic-native boundary?

A. A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. B. Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. C. Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. D. Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs.

Answer: B. Explanation: Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions,

Q39. Which statement uses Endemic-native boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. B. A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. C. Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. D. Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another.

Answer: C. Explanation: Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Endemic-native boundary?

A. Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. B. A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. C. A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. D. Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting.

Answer: D. Explanation: Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Range-record boundary?

A. A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range. B. Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. C. A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. D. Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another.

Answer: A. Explanation: A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q42. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Range-record boundary?

A. A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. B. A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range. C. A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. D. Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another.

Answer: B. Explanation: A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable

expanded range. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q43. Which statement uses Range-record boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. B. Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. C. A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range. D. A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry.

Answer: C. Explanation: A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Range-record boundary?

A. A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend. B. Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. C. A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. D. A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range.

Answer: D. Explanation: A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Habitat-range boundary?

A. Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. B. A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. C. A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. D. Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another.

Answer: A. Explanation: Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q46. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Habitat-range boundary?

A. A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. B. Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. C. A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. D. Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb.

Answer: B. Explanation: Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q47. Which statement uses Habitat-range boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. B. A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend. C. Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. D. Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb.

Answer: C. Explanation: Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Habitat-range boundary?

A. A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend. B. Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. C. IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. D. Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs.

Answer: D. Explanation: Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Population-status boundary?

A. Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. B. Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. C. A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. D. A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates.

Answer: A. Explanation: Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q50. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Population-status boundary?

A. Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. B. Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. C. A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. D. A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend.

Answer: B. Explanation: Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q51. Which statement uses Population-status boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. B. A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend. C. Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. D. Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb.

Answer: C. Explanation: Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Population-status boundary?

A. IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. B. Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. C. A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend. D. Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another.

Answer: D. Explanation: Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Trigger-static boundary?

A. A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. B. A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. C. Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. D. A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend.

Answer: A. Explanation: A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions,

Q54. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Trigger-static boundary?

A. A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend. B. A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. C. Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. D. IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status.

Answer: B. Explanation: A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q55. Which statement uses Trigger-static boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. B. Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. C. A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. D. A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend.

Answer: C. Explanation: A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Trigger-static boundary?

A. Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. B. IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. C. Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. D. A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates.

Answer: D. Explanation: A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies News-notification boundary?

A. A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. B. A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend. C. IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. D. Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb.

Answer: A. Explanation: A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. The other options

belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q58. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of News-notification boundary?

A. Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. B. A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. C. IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. D. A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend.

Answer: B. Explanation: A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q59. Which statement uses News-notification boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. B. Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. C. A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. D. Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly.

Answer: C. Explanation: A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about News-notification boundary?

A. A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. B. Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. C. Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. D. A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry.

Answer: D. Explanation: A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Status-verb boundary?

A. Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. B. Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. C. IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. D. A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend.

Answer: A. Explanation: Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q62. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Status-verb boundary?

A. IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. B. Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. C. Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. D. Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly.

Answer: B. Explanation: Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q63. Which statement uses Status-verb boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. B. Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. C. Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. D. Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly.

Answer: C. Explanation: Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Status-verb boundary?

A. A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. B. Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. C. Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. D. Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb.

Answer: D. Explanation: Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Rediscovery boundary?

A. A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend. B. Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. C. IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. D. Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes.

Answer: A. Explanation: A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Rediscovery boundary?

A. Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. B. A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend. C. Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. D. A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record.

Answer: B. Explanation: A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q67. Which statement uses Rediscovery boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. B. Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. C. A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend. D. Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region.

Answer: C. Explanation: A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Rediscovery boundary?

A. Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. B. A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. C. Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another. D. A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend.

Answer: D. Explanation: A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Cross-source reconciliation?

A. IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. B. A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. C. Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. D. Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes.

Answer: A. Explanation: IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q70. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Cross-source reconciliation?

A. Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. B. IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. C. A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. D. Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region.

Answer: B. Explanation: IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q71. Which statement uses Cross-source reconciliation without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another. B. Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. C. IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. D. A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record.

Answer: C. Explanation: IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Cross-source reconciliation?

A. Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. B. A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry. C. Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another. D. IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status.

Answer: D. Explanation: IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors,

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Stale-current firewall?

A. Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. B. Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. C. Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. D. A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record.

Answer: A. Explanation: Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Stale-current firewall?

A. Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. B. Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. C. A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. D. Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another.

Answer: B. Explanation: Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q75. Which statement uses Stale-current firewall without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry. B. Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. C. Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. D. Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another.

Answer: C. Explanation: Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Stale-current firewall?

A. A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry. B. Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another. C. An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. D. Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes.

Answer: D. Explanation: Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Current evidence boundary?

A. Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. B. Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another. C. A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. D. Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region.

Answer: A. Explanation: Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Current evidence boundary?

A. Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. B. Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. C. A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry. D. Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another.

Answer: B. Explanation: Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q79. Which statement uses Current evidence boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another. B. A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry. C. Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. D. An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing.

Answer: C. Explanation: Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Current evidence boundary?

A. A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry. B. An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. C. A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. D. Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly.

Answer: D. Explanation: Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

AUDITED SPECIES IDENTITY, ECOLOGY, RANGE, STATUS AND CURRENT-AFFAIRS PYQ OWNERSHIP

Audited ledgers route species identity, behaviour, range and institution questions, including provisionally keyed 2026 and answer-free objective demands. No option, species status, range, population or listing is inferred.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: Recurring Prelims pattern: questions increasingly combine a static concept with a requirement to identify or apply the latest verified current-affairs instance of that concept (e.g., "which of the following is India's most recently added Ramsar site").
- ANALYSIS: Mains linkage: dated current anchors (COP29/30 outcomes, Ramsar milestone, Tiger Reserve expansion) provide the "CURRENT: current anchor" evidence expected in a well-rounded GS-III answer.

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	36	Foxtail orchid distribution, epiphytic habit, and State-flower status	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans-2026-GS1-Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Foxtail orchid distribution, epiphytic habit, and State-flower status

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented:** 2024, 2025
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Prelims GS-I	25	Behaviour of big cats (lions, cheetahs, leopards)	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2025	Prelims GS-I	37	Peacock (Gooty) tarantula - endemic species	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Behaviour of big cats (lions, cheetahs, leopards)
- Peacock (Gooty) tarantula - endemic species

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md`. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 13

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Prelims GS-I	86	Prosopis juliflora invasive plant ecological biodiversity impact	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	31	Himalayan nettle Girardinia diversifolia sustainable uses	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	72	Indian elephants ecology gestation calving and state distribution	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	74	Indian bird species frogmouth barbet minivet redstart identification	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	77	Musk deer natural habitat in Himalayan protected areas	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	21	Plants used as natural mosquito repellents	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	23	Animals rolling up to protect vulnerable body parts	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2021	Prelims GS-I	63	Moringa drumstick tamarind tree properties and uses	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	Prelims GS-I	45	Himalayan forest fungus species characteristics and cultivation	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Stem verified against official scan; OCR artifact resolved; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	14	Nocturnal behaviour among Indian fauna species	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	15	Waggle dance communication in honeybee colonies	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	17	Indian squirrel nesting food-storage and dietary behaviour	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	19	Orangutan tool-making behaviour stick scraping insects	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Prosopis juliflora invasive plant ecological biodiversity impact
- Himalayan nettle Girardinia diversifolia sustainable uses
- Indian elephants ecology gestation calving and state distribution
- Indian bird species frogmouth barbet minivet redstart identification
- Musk deer natural habitat in Himalayan protected areas
- Plants used as natural mosquito repellents
- Animals rolling up to protect vulnerable body parts
- Moringa drumstick tamarind tree properties and uses
- Himalayan forest fungus species characteristics and cultivation
- Nocturnal behaviour among Indian fauna species
- Waggle dance communication in honeybee colonies
- Indian squirrel nesting food-storage and dietary behaviour
- Orangutan tool-making behaviour stick scraping insects

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: Prelims questions increasingly test the *most recent* verified instance of a recurring category (latest Ramsar site, latest Tiger Reserve, latest COP outcome) - maintaining a disciplined, dated tracker is the most reliable preparation method for this question type.
- ANALYSIS: Mains answers should demonstrate the cross-topic synthesis technique (Section 2), explicitly connecting a current-affairs anchor to at least one relevant static-concept file for full analytical credit.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Design a reliable species current-affairs tracker entry. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Tracker-record boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Taxonomic-identity boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Common-name boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Trigger-static boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Status-verb boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Stale-current firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record.
- Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region.
- A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry.
- A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates.
- Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb.
- Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Tracker-record boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:**

The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Taxonomic-identity boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Common-name boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Trigger-static boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Status-verb boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Stale-current firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish IUCN, WPA, CITES and CMS status claims. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** IUCN-assessment boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** IUCN-date boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** WPA-legal boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CITES-listing boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CMS-listing boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and

cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing.
- A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse.
- A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category.
- A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule.
- A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: IUCN-assessment boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** IUCN-date boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** WPA-legal boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CITES-listing boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CMS-listing boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain endemic, native, range, habitat and occurrence distinctions. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Endemic-native boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Range-record boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Habitat-range boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting.
- A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range.
- Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Endemic-native boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Range-record boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Habitat-range boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain why population, trend and risk category require separate evidence. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Species-subspecies boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** IUCN-assessment boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Population-status boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another.
- An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing.
- Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another.
- Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Species-subspecies boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** IUCN-assessment boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Population-status boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make

the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate a rediscovery or new-sighting claim through a verification protocol. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Taxonomic-identity boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region.

Analysis: This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Species-subspecies boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another.

Analysis: This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Range-record boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:**

The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** News-notification boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:**

The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Status-verb boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:**

The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Rediscovery boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:**

The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Cross-source reconciliation. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:**

The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. **Analysis:**

This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region.

- Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another.
- A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range.
- A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry.
- Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb.
- A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend.
- IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status.
- Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Taxonomic-identity boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Species-subspecies boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Range-record boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** News-notification boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Status-verb boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Rediscovery boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Cross-source reconciliation. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or

CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Build a static-plus-current species answer without stale or conflated status claims. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Tracker-record boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** IUCN-assessment boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** WPA-legal boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CITES-listing boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CMS-listing boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemic-native boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Population-status boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Trigger-static boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Cross-source reconciliation. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can

show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status.

Analysis: This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Stale-current firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record.
- An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing.
- A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category.
- A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule.
- A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly.
- Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting.
- Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another.
- A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates.
- IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status.
- Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes.
- Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Tracker-record boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** IUCN-assessment boundary. **Named evidence/example:** An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** WPA-legal boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the

applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CITES-listing boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CMS-listing boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemic-native boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Population-status boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Trigger-static boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Cross-source reconciliation. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Stale-current firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Environment and Ecology | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** GS-III (Environment) + Prelims, current-affairs integration across all GS papers. **Core area:** Dated species and policy current-affairs tracking methodology. **Grounded in:** PIB press releases; MoEFCC/NTCA/Ramsar Convention/IUCN/CMS/CITES official updates; audited UPSC Environment PYQs (2024-2026 Prelims and 2024-2025 Mains). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = inference/analysis | **CURRENT:** = dated current-affairs anchor. *Companion:* basic/28_Species-and-Current-Affairs-Tracker.md.

1. Why verification discipline is itself an examinable analytical skill

ANALYSIS: The advanced-level insight this tracker file embodies: in a fast-moving policy domain like environment and ecology, the ability to distinguish a *verified, source-dated fact* from an *unverified, approximate, or outdated claim* is itself a skill UPSC Mains answers implicitly reward through the precision and currency of cited evidence. An answer that cites a specific PIB press release number and date for a claim demonstrates a categorically different standard of evidentiary discipline than one that vaguely asserts "India has many Ramsar sites" or cites a stale, superseded figure. This tracker's discipline - omitting any claim that cannot be traced to a specific official source - models the standard advanced answers should aspire to.

2. Cross-topic synthesis: using tracker entries to build integrated Mains answers

Tracker entry	Cross-topic synthesis opportunity
FACT: India's 100th Ramsar site (5 June 2026, PIB PRID 2269208)	Combine with Topic 07 (Ramsar mechanism/Montreux Record) and Topic 14 (wetland water-quality governance) for an integrated wetland-policy answer.
FACT: 58th Tiger Reserve (Madhav, March 2025)	Combine with Topic 06 (protected-area hierarchy) and Topic 05 (IUCN/endemism) for an integrated species-conservation-governance answer.
FACT: COP29/COP30 NCQG outcome	Combine with Topic 19 (UNFCCC architecture) and Topic 20 (India's Panchamrit/LT-LEDS finance-conditionality) for an integrated climate-diplomacy answer.
FACT: CBD COP16/Cali Fund (2024-25)	Combine with Topic 22 (CBD/KMGBF) and Topic 04 (genetic diversity) to explain DSI benefit-sharing and implementation finance.
FACT: ISFR 2023 forest-cover data	Combine with Topic 03 (successional-quality critique) and Topic 12 (CAMPA/GIM implementation-gap critique) for an integrated forest-governance answer.

ANALYSIS: Analytical point: the highest-scoring Mains answers in this subject typically weave together a static conceptual framework (from Topics 01-27) with at least one precisely dated current-affairs anchor (from this tracker) and an explicit analytical synthesis connecting them - rather than treating "current affairs" and "static syllabus" as separate, unrelated preparation tracks.

3. A discipline for handling genuinely uncertain or contested figures

- ANALYSIS:** When a widely circulated figure (e.g., in coaching-material summaries or secondary news reports) cannot be traced to a specific primary source, the disciplined approach is to either omit it entirely from a written answer or explicitly qualify it (e.g., "reports suggest approximately X, though this should be verified against the latest official source") rather than presenting it with false precision.
- ANALYSIS:** Where official sources themselves show discrepancy (e.g., different government documents citing slightly different counts for the same category due to different reporting-cutoff dates), the precise, defensible approach is to cite the specific source and its date explicitly, allowing the discrepancy to be attributed to reporting-timing differences rather than presenting either figure as the single "correct" answer.

3. **ANALYSIS:** This discipline directly parallels the "data and conceptual limitations" sections included in every advanced-tier file across this knowledge base - treating measurement and reporting uncertainty as a first-class analytical consideration, not a gap to be silently smoothed over.

4. Species-specific tracking: the analytical value of longitudinal case studies

- **ANALYSIS:** Tracking a single flagship species (e.g., the Great Indian Bustard) across multiple tracker updates over time - IUCN status, Wildlife Protection Act Schedule status, Supreme Court proceedings, CMS-relevant range considerations - builds a longitudinal case study that is far more analytically valuable in a Mains answer than any single static fact, because it demonstrates the *interaction* of multiple governance layers (science, domestic law, judicial enforcement, international convention) around one concrete, well-documented example.
- **ANALYSIS: Recommended practice:** maintain this kind of longitudinal tracking for a small number (three to five) of the most exam-relevant flagship species/sites (e.g., Great Indian Bustard, a prominent Ramsar site, a recently notified Tiger Reserve) rather than attempting exhaustive tracking of every possible current-affairs item, prioritising depth and cross-governance-layer understanding over breadth.

5. Data and conceptual limitations

- **ANALYSIS:** This tracker's entries reflect verification as of their stated compilation date; new Ramsar sites, Tiger Reserves, COP outcomes and species-status changes will continue to occur after this date, requiring periodic re-verification against the cited primary sources before reuse in any future exam-preparation cycle.
- **ANALYSIS:** International comparative claims (e.g., "India has the highest number of Ramsar sites in Asia") depend on other countries' concurrent site counts, which also change over time - such comparative claims should be re-verified against the latest Ramsar Secretariat global data rather than treated as a permanently fixed ranking.
- **ANALYSIS:** Court-proceeding status (e.g., the Great Indian Bustard power-line case) evolves with each hearing/order; any specific claim about "the current state" of such litigation should be dated to the most recent verified order before being cited in an answer.

6. Recurring UPSC analytical tensions

Tension	Balanced framing
Comprehensive current-affairs coverage vs depth of understanding	Prioritise depth (a small number of well-understood, cross-governance-layer case studies) over attempting exhaustive breadth of every possible news item.
Citing precise figures for authority vs risk of citing outdated/incorrect figures	Precision should always be paired with source/date attribution; an unverifiable precise-sounding figure is analytically worse than an appropriately qualified estimate.
Static syllabus preparation vs current-affairs preparation	The two should be integrated (concept plus dated anchor), not treated as separate, competing preparation tracks.

7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims

- **FACT:** Verification discipline (source and date attribution for every current-affairs claim) is itself an examinable evidentiary standard reflected in the structure of this entire knowledge base.
- **FACT:** Longitudinal tracking of a small number of flagship species/sites across multiple governance layers (science, domestic law, judicial enforcement, international convention) provides higher-value Mains-answer material than isolated, single-fact current-affairs items.
- **FACT:** International comparative claims (e.g., rankings among countries) are time-sensitive and require re-verification against the latest primary-source data before being restated.
- **FACT:** Where official sources show discrepancies in reported figures, the defensible approach is to cite each source's specific date rather than asserting a single unqualified "correct" number.

8. Advanced Prelims traps

- **WRONG:** A precise-sounding but unverifiable figure is always preferable to a qualified estimate in an exam answer. -> An unverifiable precise figure risks factual error; qualified, source-attributed estimates are the more defensible practice.
- **WRONG:** Current-affairs preparation and static-syllabus preparation should be studied as entirely separate tracks. -> The highest-value preparation integrates a static concept with a precisely dated current-affairs anchor for each topic.
- **WRONG:** Once a comparative international ranking (e.g., "highest in Asia") is learned, it can be cited indefinitely without re-verification. -> Such rankings are time-sensitive and depend on other countries' concurrent data, requiring periodic re-verification.
- **WRONG:** Exhaustive coverage of every possible current-affairs item is the optimal preparation strategy. -> Depth on a small number of well-understood, cross-governance-layer flagship case studies is generally more valuable for Mains answers than exhaustive but shallow breadth.

9. CURRENT: Current anchor - analytical use

Verified current anchor	Topic-specific analytical use
CURRENT: This tracker's Section 5 entries (basic tier), each with specific source/date attribution.	Use as the model template for how to compile, verify and periodically refresh current-affairs knowledge across the entire Environment and Ecology syllabus, applying the same discipline to any newly emerging item.
CURRENT: Section 5A (basic tier) - the 2 August 2026 reevaluation batch , drawn from Economic Survey 2025-26 Ch. 10, ipcc.ch and unccd.int.	Note what makes these entries <i>usable</i> : each pairs a number with (a) an issuing authority, (b) an as-on date and (c) a status qualifier (target / allocated / installed / achieved). An entry lacking any of the three is not exam-safe.
ANALYSIS: The tracker's omissions list is itself the deliverable. Section 5A ends with an explicit statement of what could not be verified - recent CITES and Ramsar COP outcomes, post-Belém UNFCCC COPs, India's post-2025 NDC status, the global hotspot count, and India's Kigali step-down schedule.	This is the single most transferable habit in the whole knowledge base. In an examination, a candidate who writes "India's non-fossil installed capacity was 51.93% at end-December 2025 (Economic Survey 2025-26)" and then declines to guess the current global Ramsar total is demonstrating calibration - and calibration is what distinguishes a credible answer from a confident-sounding one.

ANALYSIS: Four status verbs to keep separate in every tracker entry: *announced* (a target exists), *notified* (a legal instrument exists), *allocated/sanctioned* (money or capacity is committed), and *achieved/commissioned* (physical reality). Almost every avoidable factual error in Environment answers is a substitution of one of these for another.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- **ANALYSIS:** Prelims questions increasingly test the *most recent* verified instance of a recurring category (latest Ramsar site, latest Tiger Reserve, latest COP outcome) - maintaining a disciplined, dated tracker is the most reliable preparation method for this question type.
- **ANALYSIS:** Mains answers should demonstrate the cross-topic synthesis technique (Section 2), explicitly connecting a current-affairs anchor to at least one relevant static-concept file for full analytical credit.

11. Mains-ready framework

Central thesis: Effective Environment and Ecology exam preparation requires treating current-affairs knowledge with the same evidentiary discipline as any other analytical claim - every dated fact must carry its specific source, comparative/international claims must be periodically re-verified, and depth on a small number of longitudinally tracked flagship case studies (spanning science, domestic law, judicial enforcement and international convention layers) delivers more Mains-answer value than exhaustive but shallow current-affairs breadth.

1. Explain the static-concept-plus-dated-anchor model this entire knowledge base is built around.
2. Demonstrate cross-topic synthesis using specific tracker entries (Ramsar, Tiger Reserve,

COP29/30, ISFR) linked to their respective conceptual topics.

3. Apply the verification-discipline standard to handling uncertain/discrepant figures.
4. Advocate longitudinal, cross-governance-layer tracking of a small number of flagship case studies over exhaustive breadth.
5. Conclude with a recommendation to periodically re-verify every dated claim before reuse in any future exam-preparation cycle.

12. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** Identify the most recent verified milestone for a named tracked category, applying the source/date-verification standard.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** Why should current-affairs facts in an Environment and Ecology answer always be paired with a specific source and date?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** Using a longitudinal case study (e.g., the Great Indian Bustard), demonstrate how science, domestic law, judicial enforcement and international convention layers interact in India's species-conservation governance.

13. Study links

- FACT: Foundation companion: `basic/28_Species-and-Current-Affairs-Tracker.md`.
- FACT: `05_IUCN-Red-List-and-Endemism.md` and `advanced/05_IUCN-Red-List-and-Endemism.md` - the

Great Indian Bustard longitudinal case study in full.

- FACT: `07_Biosphere-Reserves-and-Ramsar-Sites.md` - the Ramsar milestone's full conceptual and governance-gap context.
- FACT: `19_UNFCCC-COP-Kyoto-Paris-Agreement.md` - the COP29/30 climate-finance outcomes in full analytical depth.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Species and Current Affairs Tracker: TAXONOMY, RANGE, STATUS SYSTEM AND TRACKER-RECORD MAP

1. **Tracker-record boundary:** A species current-affairs record must contain the taxon, claim type, source, publication or assessment date, status verb, verification date and static-topic link; a headline alone is not a record.
2. **Taxonomic-identity boundary:** Scientific name, author-accepted taxon and taxonomic rank identify the organism; a common name may refer to more than one taxon or vary by region.
3. **Species-subspecies boundary:** Species, subspecies, population and regional assessment are different units; a claim about one unit must not be transferred to another.
4. **Common-name boundary:** A vernacular or media name is a discovery aid, not sufficient identity evidence; the verified scientific name should anchor the tracker entry.
5. **IUCN-assessment boundary:** An IUCN Red List category is an assessment outcome for a stated taxon, geographic scope and assessment version or date; it is not a domestic legal listing.
6. **IUCN-date boundary:** A Red List category can become stale when reassessed; every status claim should carry the cited assessment or publication date and be rechecked before reuse.
7. **WPA-legal boundary:** A Wildlife (Protection) Act schedule entry is a domestic legal classification under the applicable Act and amendment, not an IUCN extinction-risk category.
8. **CITES-listing boundary:** A CITES Appendix listing governs international trade through the Convention's permit system; it does not by itself state IUCN risk or domestic protection schedule.
9. **CMS-listing boundary:** A CMS Appendix or agreement concerns migratory-species conservation and cooperation; migratory status, Appendix listing and a separate instrument must be recorded distinctly.

10. **Endemic-native boundary:** Endemic means naturally restricted to a defined geographic area, while native means naturally occurring there but possibly elsewhere; neither is inferred from cultural prominence or a single sighting.
11. **Range-record boundary:** A verified range is built from accepted occurrence and distribution evidence; a sighting outside a familiar area may be a record requiring validation, not immediate proof of a stable expanded range.
12. **Habitat-range boundary:** Habitat association describes ecological use, while geographic range describes distribution; an organism using a habitat type is not necessarily present everywhere that habitat occurs.
13. **Population-status boundary:** Population size, trend, subpopulation structure and extinction-risk category are distinct claims with different evidence and dates; one cannot be inferred from another.
14. **Trigger-static boundary:** A verified current trigger such as a dated assessment, notification, conference decision, survey or rediscovery must be separated from the static taxonomy, ecology and legal framework it illustrates.
15. **News-notification boundary:** A press report or announcement can flag an event, but a legal listing or designation claim requires the applicable official notification, decision or authoritative database entry.
16. **Status-verb boundary:** Observed, reported, assessed, listed, notified, proposed, adopted and entered into force describe different evidence states; tracker wording must preserve the source's verb.
17. **Rediscovery boundary:** A rediscovery or new locality record does not automatically change IUCN status, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing, total range or population trend.
18. **Cross-source reconciliation:** IUCN, domestic law, CITES, CMS and taxonomic databases answer different questions and can show different dates without contradiction; reconcile by claim type rather than choosing one universal status.
19. **Stale-current firewall:** Every dated entry should display an as-of or verification date and a recheck trigger; undated words such as current, latest or recently should be avoided in reusable notes.
20. **Current evidence boundary:** Species status, range, population, legal schedule, CITES or CMS listing and news trigger require dated official or authoritative source evidence; failed checks and omitted claims must be recorded honestly.

Species and Current Affairs Tracker: ASSESSMENT, LEGAL LISTING, DATE, SIGHTING AND STALE-CURRENT TRAPS

- Do not use a headline as a tracker record.
- Do not rely on a common name for taxonomic identity.
- Do not merge species, subspecies and populations.
- Do not transfer a claim between taxa sharing a common name.
- Do not call IUCN status a domestic legal schedule.
- Do not cite an IUCN category without an assessment date.
- Do not call a WPA schedule an extinction-risk assessment.
- Do not call a CITES Appendix an IUCN category.
- Do not merge CMS migratory status with every international listing.
- Do not infer endemism from prominence or one location.
- Do not infer stable range expansion from one sighting.
- Do not merge habitat association with geographic range.
- Do not infer population trend from risk category.
- Do not merge a dated trigger with the static anchor.
- Do not rewrite a news report as a legal notification.
- Do not change the source's status verb.
- Do not turn rediscovery into automatic status change.
- Do not seek one universal status across unlike systems.

- Do not use stale-current language without an as-of date.
- Do not invent species status, range, population, listing, date or news.

Species and Current Affairs Tracker: SPECIES CURRENT-AFFAIRS ANSWER SPINE

IDENTIFY SCIENTIFIC NAME TAXONOMIC RANK AND CLAIM UNIT

- > SEPARATE IUCN ASSESSMENT WPA SCHEDULE CITES AND CMS LISTING
- > SEPARATE ENDEMIC NATIVE RANGE HABITAT POPULATION AND TREND
- > DATE EVERY ASSESSMENT NOTIFICATION LISTING AND CURRENT TRIGGER
- > PRESERVE OBSERVED ASSESSED LISTED NOTIFIED AND EFFECTIVE STATUS VERBS
- > PAIR A VERIFIED DATED ITEM WITH ITS STATIC CONCEPT ANCHOR
- > RECHECK OR OMIT TO PREVENT STALE-CURRENT CLAIMS

Species and Current Affairs Tracker: LIVE STATUS, RANGE, POPULATION, LISTING, DATE AND NEWS EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

The CMS species page supplied substantive field-level separation but no selected species update. CITES and IUCN checks failed and the MoEFCC page was unrelated; therefore no current species status, range, population, WPA schedule, CITES or CMS listing, effective date or news claim is asserted.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

High-yield use: Follow the panels as one topic-specific conceptual atlas: root question, classifications, processes or arguments, comparisons, objections and a final answer-writing spine. This text-native master is separate from both graphical flowchart artifacts.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Tracker entry template

TAXON -> scientific name and rank
 CLAIM TYPE -> status range population law or event
 SOURCE AND DATE -> authoritative issuer and publication
 STATUS VERB -> assessed listed notified observed or proposed
 STATIC LINK AND RECHECK -> concept owner plus expiry trigger

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Taxonomic identity ladder

SCIENTIFIC NAME -> primary identity anchor
 RANK -> species subspecies population or other unit
 COMMON NAME -> secondary discovery label
 TAXONOMIC AUTHORITY -> accepted identity evidence
 RULE -> never transfer claims between units

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Five-status firewall

IUCN -> extinction-risk assessment
 WPA SCHEDULE -> domestic legal protection classification
 CITES APPENDIX -> international trade-control listing
 CMS APPENDIX OR INSTRUMENT -> migratory cooperation
 TAXONOMY -> organism identity, not conservation status

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: IUCN assessment card

TAXON -> exact assessed unit
GEOGRAPHIC SCOPE -> global or stated regional assessment
CATEGORY -> assessment outcome
VERSION OR DATE -> currency boundary
RECHECK -> later assessment can supersede the claim

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Legal and treaty date rail

DOMESTIC SCHEDULE -> Act and applicable amendment date
CITES LISTING -> Appendix and effective trade date
CMS LISTING -> Appendix or instrument and decision date
SEPARATE DATABASES -> answer different questions
RULE -> no cross-system automatic conversion

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Range vocabulary map

ENDEMIC -> naturally restricted to defined geography
NATIVE -> naturally occurs there and may occur elsewhere
RESIDENT -> present through relevant annual cycle
MIGRATORY -> regular movement across areas or seasons
SIGHTING -> occurrence record, not full range proof

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Habitat and population screen

HABITAT ASSOCIATION -> ecological use
GEOGRAPHIC RANGE -> distribution envelope
POPULATION SIZE -> estimate for stated unit and date
POPULATION TREND -> direction across a period
RISK CATEGORY -> assessment, not a census

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Trigger-static bridge

STATIC ANCHOR -> taxonomy ecology law or treaty concept
DATED TRIGGER -> assessment notification decision or survey
SOURCE VERB -> observed assessed listed notified or adopted
EXAM USE -> one current example with its limit
UPDATE RULE -> recheck when source changes

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: News-to-proof decision tree

NEWS OR PRESS RELEASE -> discovery lead
LEGAL CLAIM -> find official notification or decision
STATUS CLAIM -> find authoritative assessment database
RANGE OR POPULATION CLAIM -> find dated study or database
NO PRIMARY SUPPORT -> omit and record failure

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: Rediscovery firewall

NEW OBSERVATION -> possible rediscovery or locality record
IDENTITY VALIDATION -> taxonomic confirmation
RANGE INTERPRETATION -> evidence synthesis
FORMAL REASSESSMENT OR LISTING -> separate process
RULE -> observation alone changes no status automatically

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Cross-source reconciliation

IDENTITY QUESTION -> taxonomic source
EXTINCTION-RISK QUESTION -> IUCN assessment
DOMESTIC LEGAL QUESTION -> WPA text
TRADE OR MIGRATION QUESTION -> CITES or CMS
CURRENT TRIGGER -> dated official decision or study

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Species tracker answer spine

IDENTIFY -> scientific name rank and claim unit
SEPARATE -> IUCN WPA CITES CMS range and population
DATE -> assessment legal listing and trigger independently
PAIR -> dated verified item with static anchor
RECHECK OR OMIT -> prevent stale-current claims